

Forest Land Diversion Dashboard –Dashboard, Insights, Recommendations & Conclusion

Analysis of Forest Land Diversion Dashboard

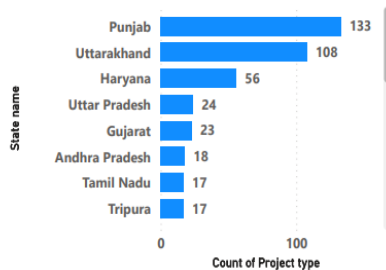
3,573.62
Total Land In Hect

23
Total States

490
Total Projects

Project type State name
All All

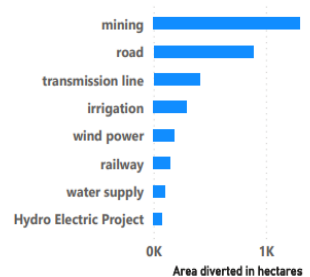
Forest Diversion Project Count by State



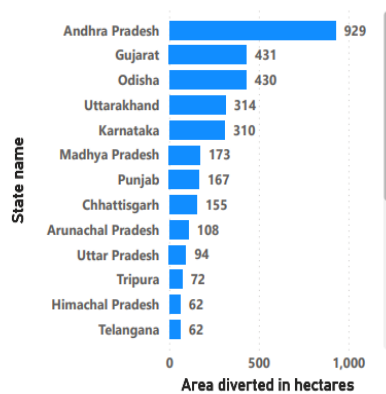
Year-wise Project Distribution



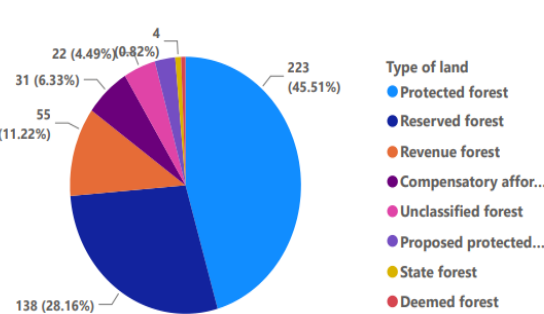
Total Area Diverted by Project Type



Area Diverted (Hectares) by State



Number of Projects by Land Type



State name	Count of Project type
West Bengal	2
Uttarakhand	15
Uttar Pradesh	6
Tripura	4
Telangana	1
Tamil Nadu	8
Sikkim	1
Rajasthan	6
Punjab	12
Odisha	2
Meghalaya	1
Maharashtra	3
Madhya Pradesh	6
Karnataka	7
Total	27

Insights

Overall Summary

- A total of **490 forest diversion projects** were recorded across **23 states**
- Overall **3,573.62 hectares** of forest land has been diverted

State-wise Pattern

- Punjab** has the highest number of projects (**133 projects**) indicating high fragmentation of projects
- Andhra Pradesh** has the highest land diversion area (**~929 hectares**) indicating large-scale impact projects

Forest Type Impact

- Protected Forest (~45%)** is the most affected category
- Reserved Forest (~28%)** is the second most impacted category
- Majority of diversion occurs in ecologically sensitive forest zones due to availability of large contiguous forest areas

Key Drivers

- Major contributors to forest land diversion:
 - Mining activities

- Road construction projects

Trend Analysis

- Peak project activity observed between **2005–2012**, especially during **2008–2010**
- This spike is associated with rapid infrastructure development and economic expansion
- After 2012, project activity has **stabilized with moderate fluctuations**

Pattern Analysis

- Punjab: High project count but low land area → **small-scale, fragmented infrastructure projects**
- Andhra Pradesh: Low project count but high land area → **large-scale industrial/mining projects**

Future Outlook

- Forest diversion is expected to remain **stable unless policy changes occur**
- High-risk states for future diversion:
 - Odisha
 - Madhya Pradesh
 - Andhra Pradesh
- Mining and road infrastructure will continue to be the **primary pressure factors**

Recommendations

- Strengthen **compensatory afforestation policies (1:1 or 1:2 enforcement mandatory)**
- Introduce **state-wise caps on forest land diversion** for high-impact states
- Promote **eco-friendly mining methods (underground and controlled extraction)**
- Deploy **GIS and satellite-based monitoring systems** for real-time tracking
- Encourage **project consolidation** to reduce fragmented forest damage
- Conduct **detailed audits of high-project states like Punjab**
- Strengthen approval processes for **mining and road construction in forest zones**
- Build a **centralized forest diversion monitoring dashboard**
- Improve transparency in **compensatory afforestation reporting and tracking**
- Prioritize **green infrastructure planning in future development projects**

Conclusion

- Forest land diversion has slowed compared to peak years but continues at a steady rate
- The pattern has shifted from **many small-scale projects to fewer large-scale high-impact projects**
- **Protected and Reserved forests** remain the most affected ecosystems

- Strong governance, stricter policy enforcement, and data-driven monitoring are essential to balance:
 - Economic and infrastructure development
 - Environmental sustainability and forest conservation